

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's find out who made it to the appointment on time!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in the present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about people's personalities, love and marriage.
- I can express uncertainty about past events.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- Can you remember the last time that you were late for something? What happened?
- Do you think being punctual is overrated or underrated? Explain.

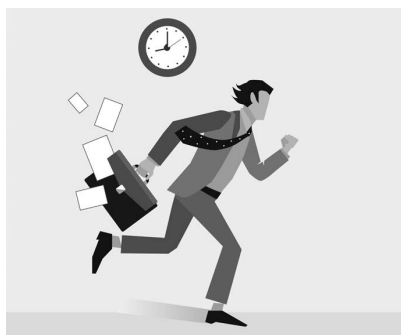




Let's Explore!

Jennifer and Alex get **mixed up***

* To get "mixed up" means to get confused.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Being a prompt and meticulous person, Jennifer was always very specific about any arrangements she made. She was never late for an appointment. Her husband Alex, on the other hand, was an easy-going fellow who was usually late.

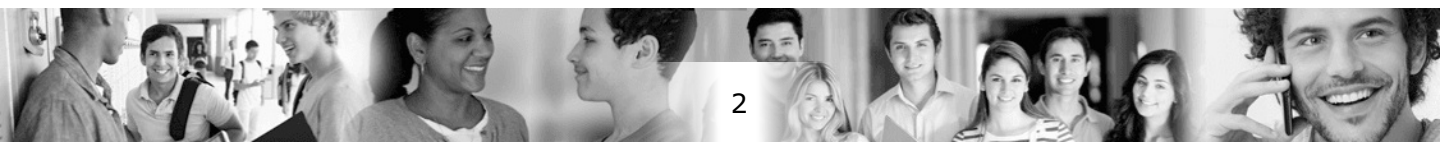
On one particular Tuesday, Jennifer and Alex decided to meet for lunch at twelve o'clock. Realizing that Alex was likely to forget, Jennifer reminded him to come on time. "Be in front of the Central Bank at exactly twelve o'clock," Jennifer said. Smiling to himself, Alex wondered how he and Jennifer could have managed to stay happily married all these years. Alex made a real effort to be on time for the lunch date, and he arrived at the bank at five minutes past twelve. He was relieved to see that Jennifer wasn't waiting for him. Evidently, she hadn't arrived yet. Alex waited at the assigned meeting place. He waited until half past twelve.

Eventually, he came to the conclusion that his wife could have arrived at the bank exactly on time, and then left. If this was the case, she hadn't waited for him for more than five minutes. Feeling very annoyed, Alex went straight home.

Upon arriving home, Alex wasn't surprised to see that Jennifer had already arrived. He flew into the house, and before Jennifer could say a word, Alex reproached her, telling her with annoyance in his voice: "I waited for you for half an hour before I realized that you had come and gone. You must have left after five minutes. You could have waited a little longer." His wife looked confused. "What are you talking about, Alex?" she said. "Where did you wait? I was in front of the bank for at least half an hour."

"That's impossible," Alex almost shouted. "You couldn't have been there. I was in front of the Midland Bank at five past twelve, and in my book, five minutes late isn't late."

"Alex," Jennifer said calmly, "you were there at the right time. The only trouble is that you were in the wrong place."





Let's Practice!

Alex and Jennifer wonder about their marriage!

Instructions: Read the sentences below. Circle the incorrect words in each sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Which sentences talk about uncertainty in the past?

- How could Jennifer have managed to stay happily married all these years?
- Alex couldn't ski or snowboard as a child.
- His wife could have arrived at the bank exactly on time, and then left.
- You could have waited a little longer.
- You could be on time in the future.
- You couldn't have been there.



Let's Practice!

Alex and Jennifer are quite different!

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below. Circle the incorrect words. Provide a correction to each mistake on top of them. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Were Being a prompt and meticulous person, Jennifer was always very specific about any arrangements she made.
2. Be Realizing that Alex was likely to forget, Jennifer reminded him to come on time.
3. Smiling Smiles to himself, Alex wondered how he and Jennifer could have managed to stay happily married all these years.
4. Feeling very annoyed, Alex went going straight home.
5. Upon was arriving home, Alex wasn't surprised to see that Jennifer had already arrived.





Extension Activity

Make a list of things you could have done.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview a partner about the past. Find out where your partner went to school and worked.
- Write ten sentences about your partner's past based on your interview.
- Rewrite each sentence using "Could have" (e.g. He could have traveled to Paris, but he went to university instead.)
- Read your new sentences to your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview a partner about the past.

☐ ☐

I write sentences about the past.

☐ ☐

I speculate about the past using "Could have".

☐ ☐

I share my ideas with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- prompt** (adjective): done without delay; immediate
e.g. Being a prompt and meticulous person, Jennifer was always very specific about any arrangements she made.
- meticulous** (adjective): showing great attention to detail; very careful and precise
e.g. Being a prompt and meticulous person, Jennifer was always very specific about any arrangements she made.
- easy-going** (adjective): relaxed and tolerant
e.g. Her husband Alex, on the other hand, was an easy-going fellow, who was usually late.
- to reproach** (verb): to express disapproval or disappointment
e.g. Before Jennifer could say a word, Alex reproached her, with annoyance in his voice.
- annoyance** (noun): the feeling or state of being annoyed; irritation
e.g. Before Jennifer could say a word, Alex reproached her, with annoyance in his voice.
- in my book** (expression): in my opinion
e.g. In my book, five minutes late isn't late.
- calmly** (adverb): in a relaxed way
e.g. "Alex," Jennifer said calmly, "you were there at the right time".





Learning Points

Perfect Modals: Could Have

To express uncertainty about past events, use the Perfect modal phrase **could have**.

You use **could have** + past participle to:

- explain that you were able to do something in the past, but didn't.

For example:

*I **could have gone** to their party, but I didn't want to.*

- talk about a suggestion that was not taken

For example:

*You **could have asked** your teacher to give you a different assignment.*

- discuss an action that nearly happened, but didn't.

For example:

*Watch out! That car **could have killed** you!*

Examples:

- Alex wondered how he and Jennifer could have managed to stay happily married all these years.
- He decided that his wife could have arrived at the bank exactly on time and then left.
- You could have waited a little longer.
- You couldn't have been there.





Learning Points

Non-Finite Clauses with *-ing*

When you think of a clause, you think of it having its own subject and verb. There are cases, however, when the clause does not contain a main verb.

These are examples of non-defining clauses and the two clauses have the same subject:

- Actions happening at the same time

Waving their hands and cheering, the guests congratulated the young couple.

- One action happening before another

Opening the envelope, she found that it contained a check for \$1,000.

You often explain the **reason for something happening** with this type of clause.

Realizing there was no one at home, I left the package on the porch.

Both these types of sentence might begin with *on* or *upon*:

On opening the envelope ... Upon realizing ...

- An event which is the result of another event

*I didn't get lost, **having remembered to bring a map**.*

Examples:

- *Being a prompt and meticulous person, Jennifer was always very specific about any arrangements she made.*
- *Realizing that Alex was likely to forget, Jennifer reminded him to come on time.*
- *Smiling to himself, Alex wondered how he and Jennifer could have managed to stay happily married all these years.*
- *Feeling very annoyed, Alex went straight home.*
- *Upon arriving home, Alex wasn't surprised to see that Jennifer had already arrived.*

